



**JUBILANT SCIENCE STUDENTS OF
LOYOLA COLLEGE, CHENNAI**

agents of change in the city they live in. But right from the 1950s, Loyola has been involved with the Madras City Corporation in research-based operations to help in city's planning. The last few years have seen the faculty and students of the college being involved in a project that has been financed by the Government of India (Information Technology) to restructure the storm water drains in Chennai, the primary cause of waterlogging and spread of water-borne diseases in the city. Thanks to the effort, there is a considerable change today. "Our students don't just conduct research, they also get to see the projects implemented," says Dr S. Vincent, professor at the department of advanced zoology and bio-technology, who led the project. Similarly, global warming is not just a subject of symposiums at Loyola. Students are actually asked to put into practice what they learn. The vermin compost pit for waste management on the campus is one such initiative. The faculty at the college has also embarked on an ambitious programme to generate 50 per cent of its power requirement through solar panels. Their constant endeavour to innovate gives Loyola an added edge.

While Vincent engages in ventures like drainage maintenance, Project Elephant and a project for the Tamil Nadu Council for Scientific Technology, others like Dr S. Ignacimuthu are on the verge of creating a vaccine for Tuberculosis. He says: "We have already worked in the lab by injecting a microbial antigen into plants that produces antibodies to be used as vaccines against TB." Grants from the UGC and other funding bodies ensure that projects are never short of funds. "The funding bodies expect transparency and good results and that is something we are always confident about," says Vincent.

Loyola received grants amounting to Rs 1 crore for research-related projects in the last academic year. Eight mous have been signed with foreign universities, taking the total number with universities and corporate bodies to 45. While the placement cell ensures that 40 per cent of the students land plum jobs, nearly 50 per cent passing out opt for research projects, most of them within the institution itself. It is also not uncommon to find Ph.D students and scholars staying back late after hours in the laboratories or the 24/7 library. The gamut of courses in the science stream includes a B.Sc in visual communication, plant

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